Rowan University

Department of Computer Science

RunSignup Mobile Timer App

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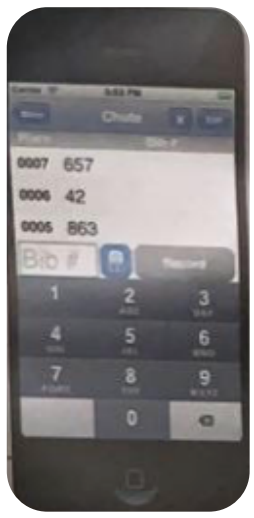
The Problem

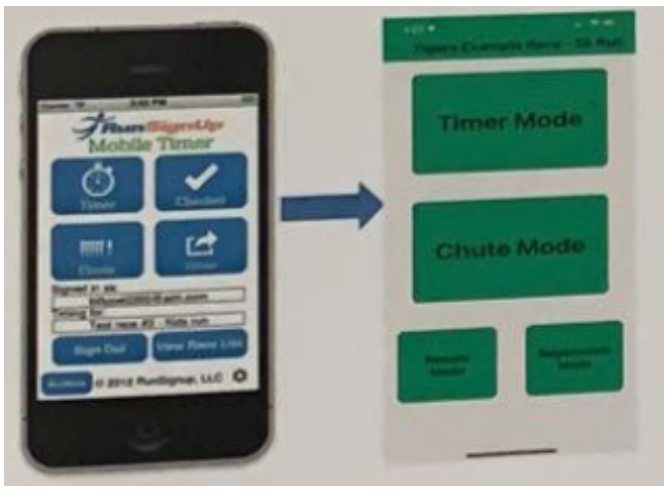
The finish line is a congested and fast-moving environment to work. Recording race results by hand has historically been a highly error prone activity, especially for untrained volunteers. Many solve this problem by utilizing expensive hardware to track individual racers. However, when it comes to low-cost or charitable races, money and resources are a scarce commodity. Our project aims to close this gap.



Nine years ago, a RunSignup intern had the opportunity to create a POC solution to this problem. While successful in demonstrating the capability, phones of the time were not able to keep up with the demand. Our aim was to rewrite this app in a modern framework, React Native, update the design elements, and ensure the app runs correctly and efficiently on current smartphones.

The Solution

Our solution features three modes of operation: marking the time of finishers, marking the order of finishers, and viewing the results of a race to check for discrepancies. Once a race is finished, the results can be viewed by all participants of the race. If there is any issue with the results set, the app also allows for the rectification of any data conflicts that are found.

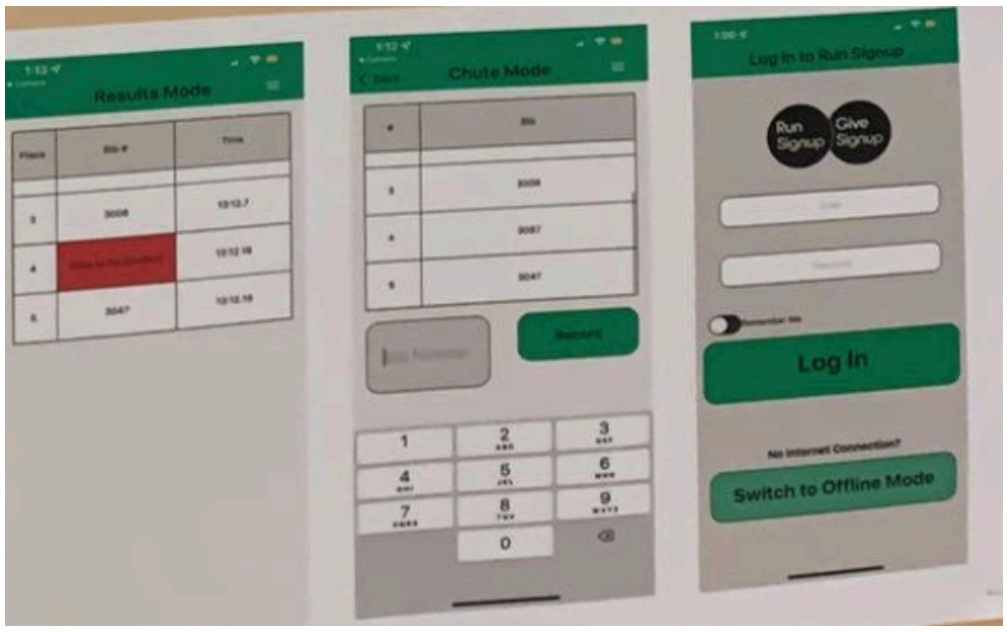


Syncing Data

After the races are finished, the app will upload the data for both the timer and chute mode using the RunSignup API. This will sync the data with their database for races and allow the results to be viewable online

Conflict Resolving

After result sets have been uploaded, the Results Mode makes it easy to avoid having conflicting entries.

Every entry with the same bib number is flagged as a conflict, making a very user-friendly way to detect any issue within seconds.

When tapping the conflicts, you can even select which time entry you would like the conflicting bib number to be on, making it as easy as possible to fix conflicts.